

KRISTOPHER BAKER

Senior Software Engineer

Product-focused engineer specializing in growth, consumer applications, and AI-enabled systems

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US Citizen • Japan Permanent Resident

SUMMARY

Software engineer with 13+ years of experience building and scaling consumer products used by millions. Most recently focused on growth and retention in subscription-based applications, delivering measurable business impact through experimentation and cross-functional collaboration.

Expanding into AI-enabled product experiences, including building a macOS application for real-time AI-driven interview simulation and feedback.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product & Growth Engineering: Subscription systems, conversion funnels, A/B testing, telemetry design, data-driven iteration

AI-Enabled Product Development: LLM integration (Anthropic, OpenAI, OpenRouter, Ollama), RAG systems, real-time speech pipelines (STT/TTS), applied multi-modal systems

Architecture & Systems Design: Modular architecture, protocol-oriented design, dependency injection, event-driven systems, backend-driven UI

Concurrency & Performance: Swift concurrency (async/await, Actors, Sendable), real-time processing, profiling, memory optimization

Languages & Platforms: Swift, Objective-C, Python; UIKit, SwiftUI, AppKit, AVFoundation

EXPERIENCE

Wolt / DoorDash | Senior Software Engineer

May 2023 – Present | Tokyo, Japan

Lead engineer for membership growth in a large-scale consumer application, owning features end-to-end from proposal through delivery and post-launch analysis.

- Led implementation of subscription funnel improvements, contributing to +29.8% incremental membership sign-ups through experimentation and iteration.
- Identified and addressed key friction points in checkout, implementing optimizations that contributed to +27,000 incremental subscribers annually.
- Served as frontend DRI for major product launches including Cart Entry Point, Express Sign-Up, and Long Distance Delivery, coordinating across iOS, Android, Web, backend, and data teams distributed across Germany, Finland, and Japan.
- Designed telemetry instrumentation and backend-driven UI systems enabling faster experimentation cycles and improved release confidence across the membership surface.
- Refactored shared UI components and standardized ViewModel patterns across checkout and discovery flows, reducing duplication and improving long-term maintainability.
- Authored technical design documents (RFCs) for cross-team architecture decisions and feature proposals.

SmartNews | Senior Software Engineer, iOS

April 2019 – May 2023 | Tokyo, Japan

Core iOS engineer on a consumer news application serving tens of millions of users globally, owning features across the full development lifecycle.

- Built and shipped features across feed rendering, onboarding, push notifications, navigation, and article display in a large-scale, performance-sensitive codebase.
- Owned feature delivery end-to-end: architecture design, implementation, testing, release planning, and post-launch iteration with metric-driven evaluation.
- Led Objective-C to Swift migration initiatives and established SwiftLint and SwiftFormat standards, improving code consistency and long-term maintainability across the iOS team.
- Implemented server-driven onboarding flows using SwiftUI, decoupling product iteration from release cycles and enabling rapid A/B testing of onboarding variants.
- Collaborated with product, backend, and ML teams across Tokyo and San Francisco to ship globally distributed features on tight timelines.
- Conducted 100+ technical interviews across engineering roles.

Bodybuilding.com | Software Engineer, iOS

March 2013 – July 2018 | Boise, Idaho

Developed native iOS applications across fitness tracking, social feed, and e-commerce products serving a large consumer user base.

- Diagnosed and resolved critical feed rendering bottlenecks using Instruments profiling and multithreaded layout computation, achieving consistent 60fps scrolling performance.
- Led early adoption of Swift and guided production applications through multiple major Swift language migrations, establishing patterns adopted across the team.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines and release automation, improving development velocity and deployment reliability.
- Awarded Company MVP for delivering critical feed functionality during a team transition while maintaining release commitments.

Projects

Aside | AI Mock Interview Coach (macOS) | Personal project (in progress)

Building a native macOS application for realistic AI-driven mock interviews with real-time conversation, adaptive questioning, and structured post-session evaluation.

- Designed a provider-agnostic LLM orchestration layer supporting Anthropic, OpenAI, OpenRouter, and local models (Ollama)
- Implemented actor-based interview orchestration system managing multi-phase conversation flow and contextual prompting
- Integrated real-time speech pipeline with on-device transcription (Parakeet) and low-latency text-to-speech (Kokoro)
- Implementing retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) system using vector embeddings and SQLite-backed storage to incorporate historical session data and context
- Developing evaluation engine producing structured feedback with competency scoring, evidence extraction, and longitudinal performance tracking

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Springfield

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | Minor: Mathematics

Summa Cum Laude